

★ Puss in Boots ★

an old fairy tale, told again



Puss in Boots

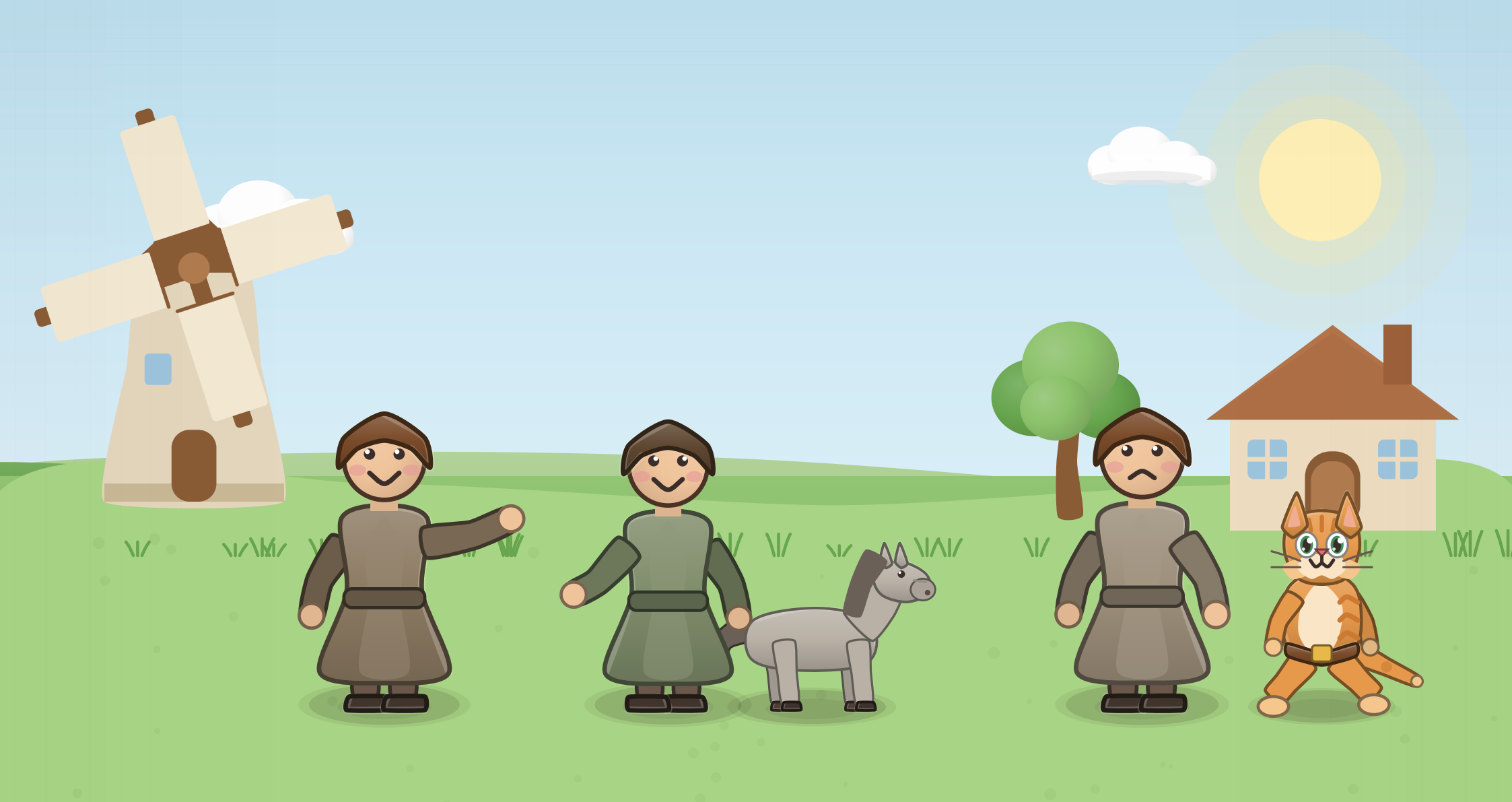
after the story by Charles Perrault



This book belongs to

A retelling of Charles Perrault's "Le Maître Chat, ou le Chat Botté", first printed in 1697.

Illustrations drawn as vector art. Made to be read aloud.



There was once a miller with three sons. When he grew old he left the mill to the eldest, and the donkey to the second, and to the youngest, Jack, he left only the cat.



“Oh dear,” said Jack. “What good is a cat to me?”
The cat looked up. “A great deal of good,” he said. “Bring me a sack, and a fine pair of boots, and you shall see.”



Jack was so astonished that he sat straight down in the straw. But he found the boots — red ones, with turned-down tops — and the cat pulled them on and stood up tall.



He put a feather in his hat. He looked at himself for a long moment. Then he purred.

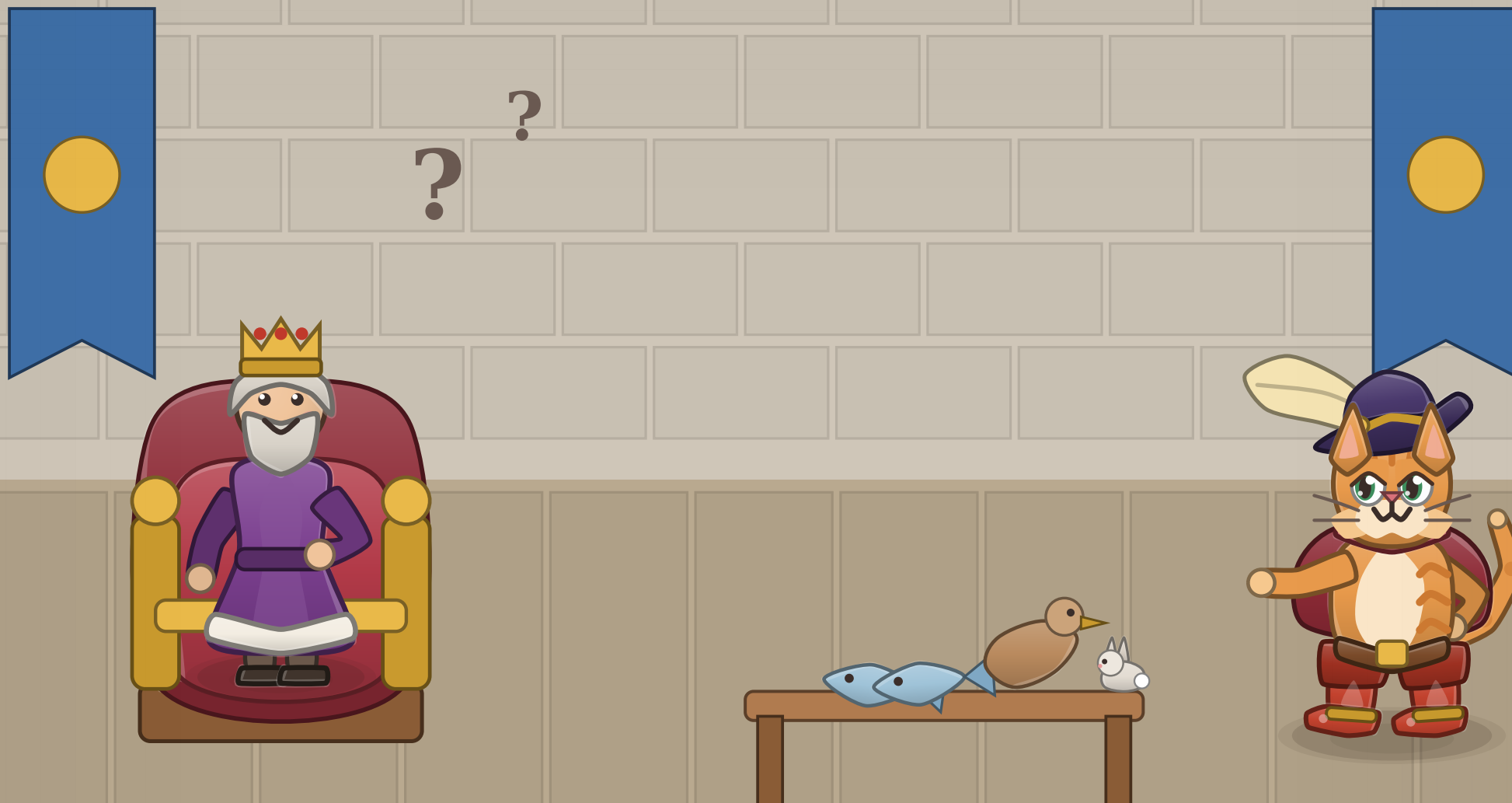
And from that day, everybody called him Puss in Boots.



Off went Puss to the meadow. He propped his sack open, dropped in two fat carrots, and lay so still that a beetle walked over his paw. Along came a plump young rabbit — and snap went the sack.



Puss marched all the way to the palace and bowed very low before the King. "A gift for Your Majesty," he said, "from my master, the Marquis of Carabas."

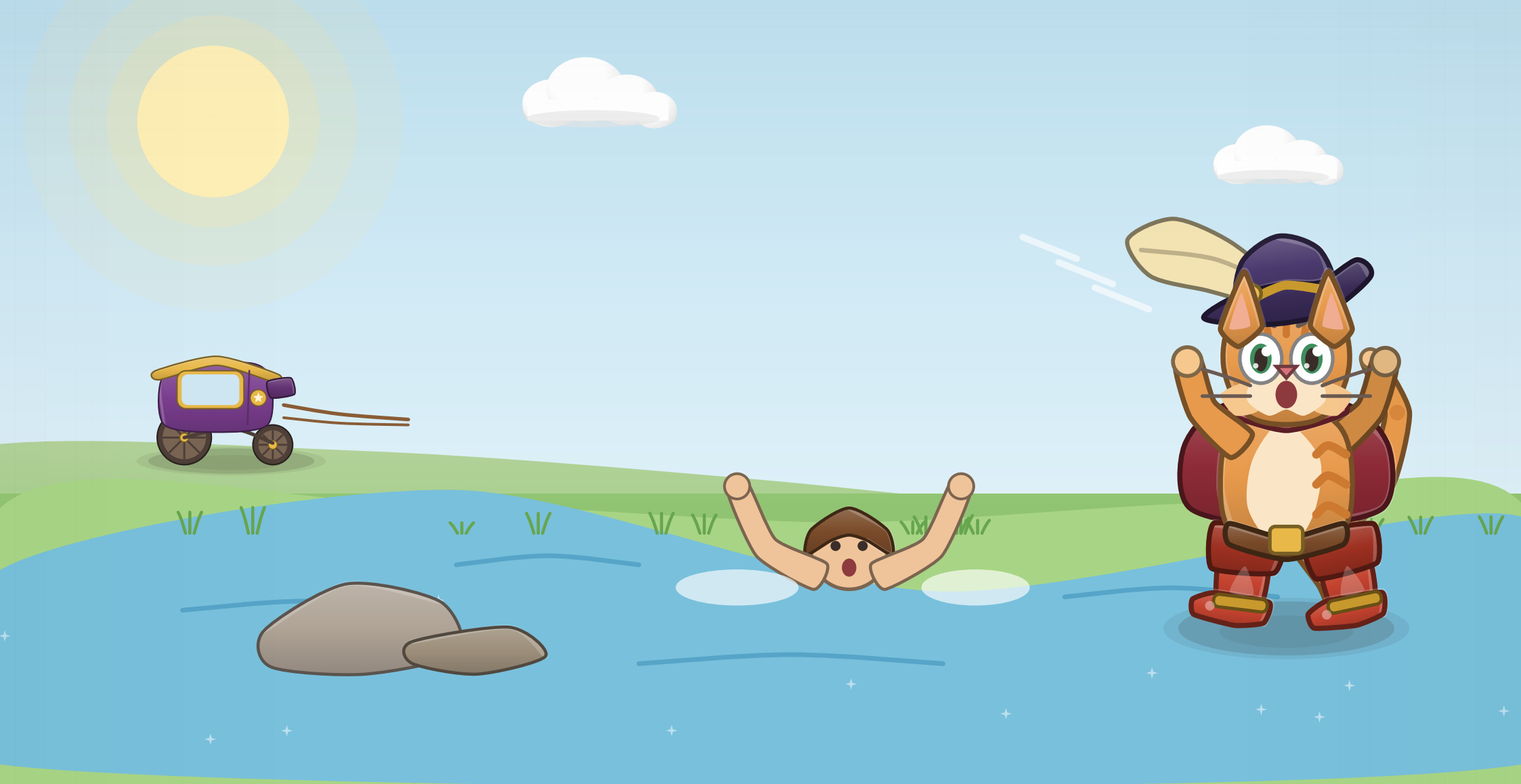


Now, there was no such person as the Marquis of Carabas. Puss had made him up on the road.

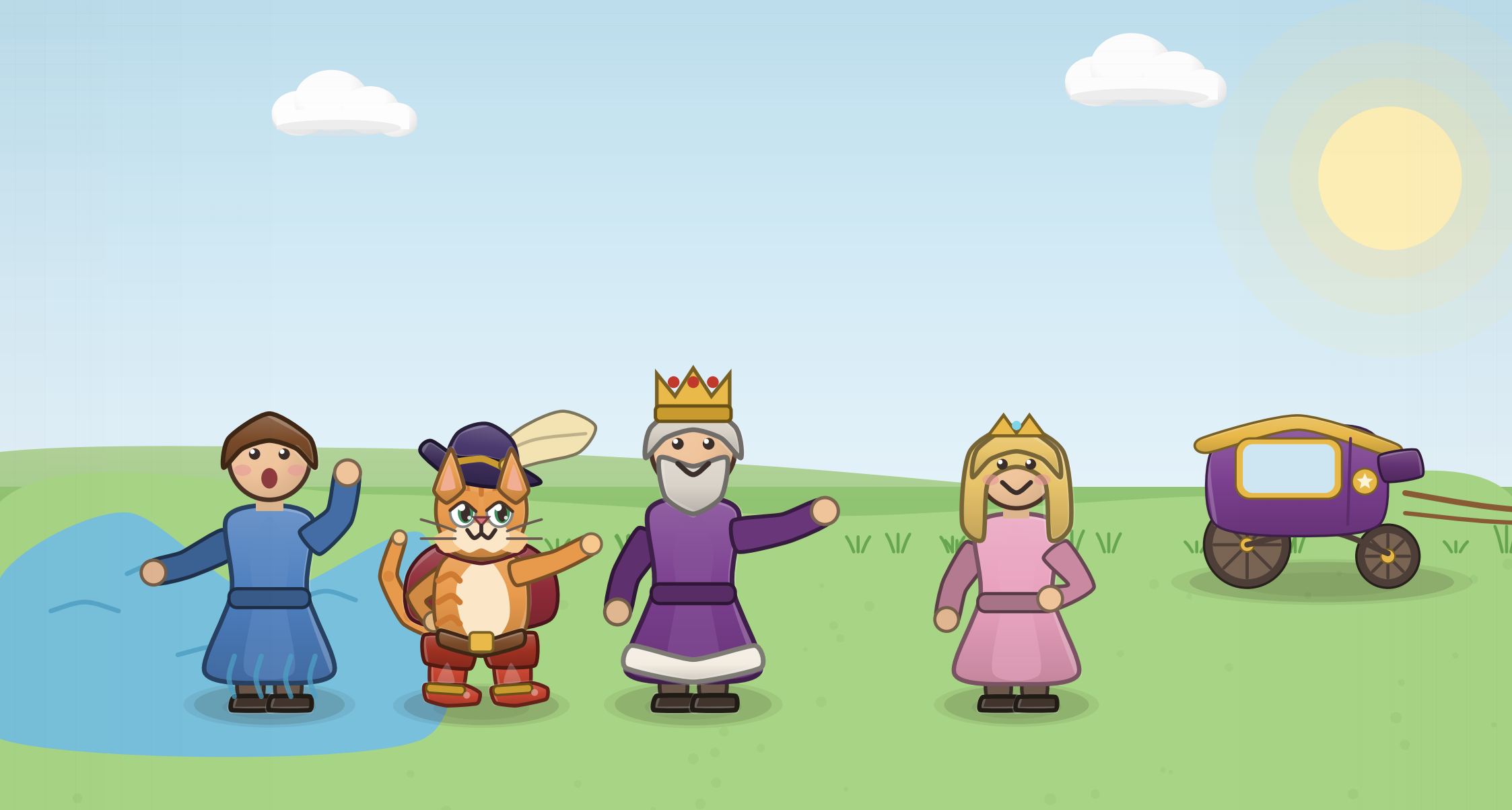
But the gifts kept coming — partridges on Monday, fish on Friday — and the King grew very curious indeed.



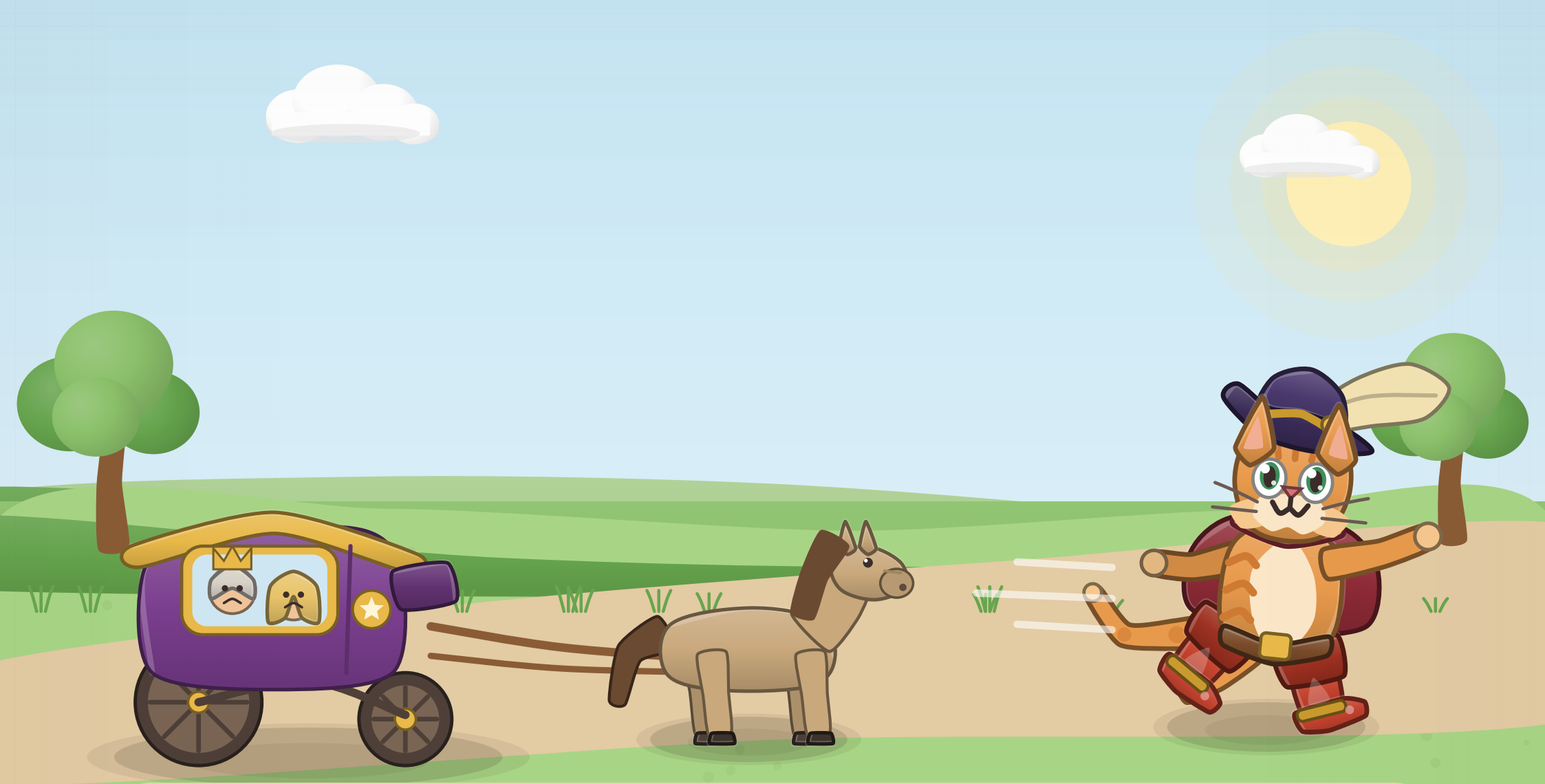
One morning Puss heard that the King would ride along the river, with the Princess beside him.
He ran home faster than the wind. "Master! Quick! Go and swim in the river!"



Jack thought this was a very silly plan. But in he went.
And while he splashed about, Puss hid his old clothes under a stone and began
to shout: “Help! Help! My master is drowning!”



The royal coach stopped at once. Servants pulled Jack out, dripping wet. "A thief has run off with his fine clothes," said Puss sadly. So the King lent him a coat of blue velvet.



The Princess thought he looked rather nice.
“Ride with us,” said the King. And Jack climbed into the golden coach, hardly
believing a moment of it.
Puss ran on ahead.



He came to great fields of wheat, where the haymakers were working in the sun.

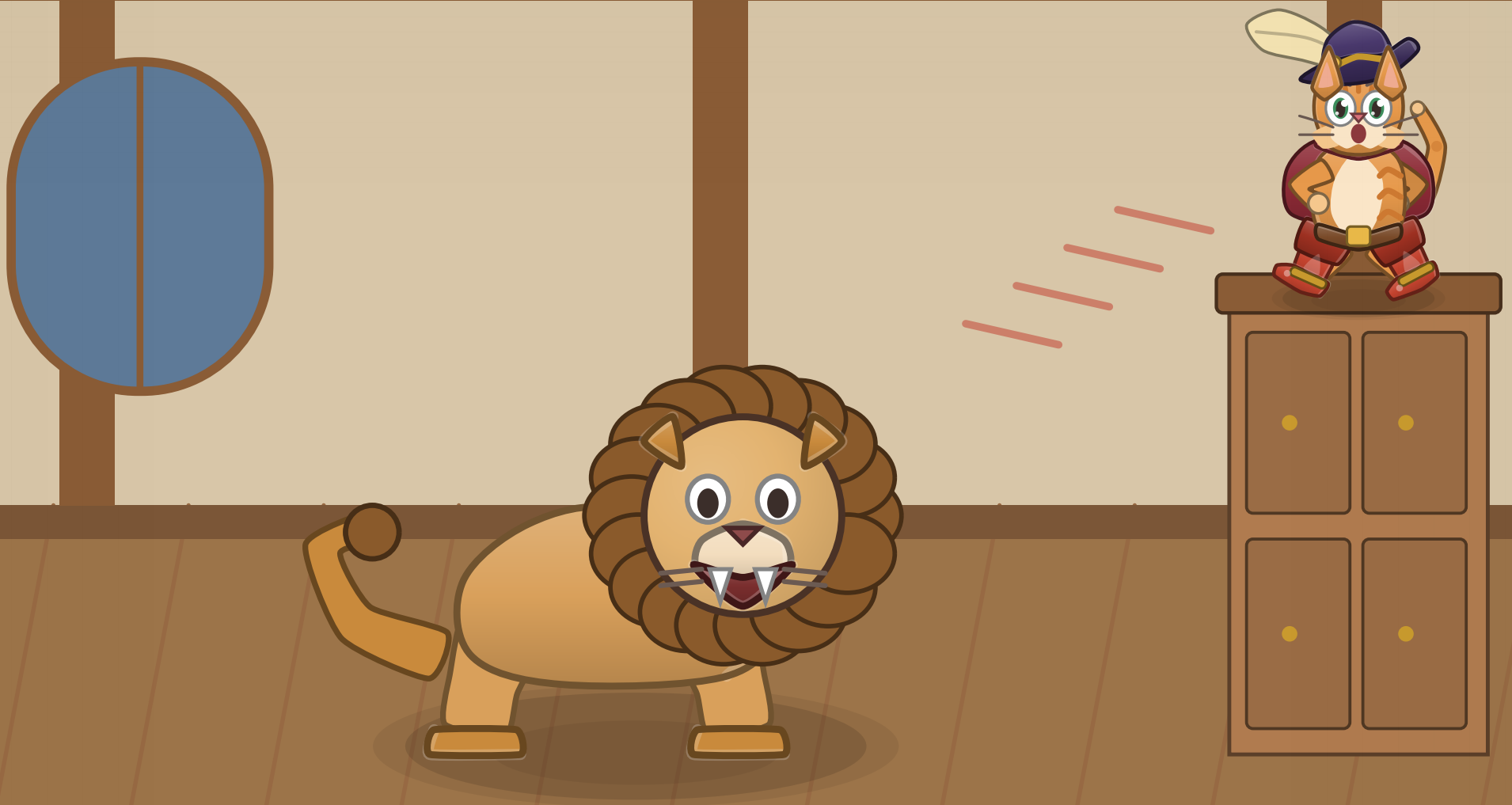
“When the King asks whose land this is,” said Puss, “you will say it belongs to the Marquis of Carabas.”

And so they did.



On ran Puss, until he came to a castle. Inside lived an Ogre, who owned every field for miles around.

Puss knocked politely. "I hear that you can do magic," he said. "Is it true?"



“Watch this!” roared the Ogre — and with a POOF he turned into a lion.
Puss leapt to the top of the cupboard. His heart went thump, thump, thump.
But he smiled all the same.



poof!



“Very fine,” said Puss. “But a big beast is easy. I don’t suppose you could manage something tiny? A mouse, perhaps?”

“Easy!” squeaked the Ogre. And poof — a mouse.



Puss chased him out of the door, down the steps and away over the hill, and the Ogre was never seen again.

Then Puss dusted off his boots and went to wait at the gate.



When the coach came rumbling up, Puss bowed low.
“Welcome, Your Majesty, to the castle of the Marquis of Carabas!”
The King was amazed. The Princess laughed. Jack could not say a word.



So Jack married the Princess, and Puss was made a lord, with a red cushion of his own beside the fire.

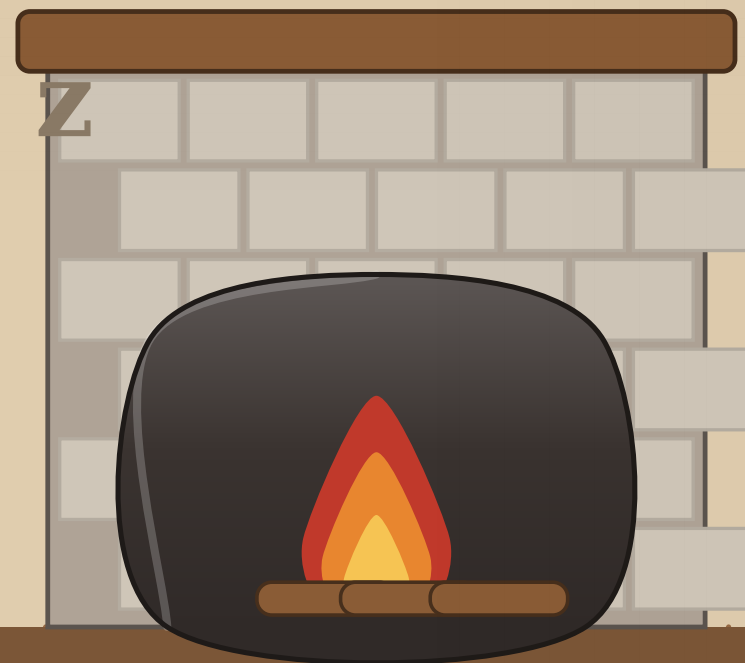
He never had to chase a mouse again — though now and then, just for the fun of it, he did.



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The End

**“Bring me a sack, and a fine pair of boots,
and you shall see.”**

